

Husqvarna Automower iQ Series

Husqvarna invented robotic mowing and has refined it for more than twenty-five years. In 2026 the AI systems that buyers increasingly ask first describe the Automower iQ line as the expensive, dated option, rank newer rivals ahead of it, and cannot complete a purchase from Husqvarna at all. This audit measures that gap across six engines and the sources those engines read, using the three current residential models as the worked case.

D

Composite AI Visibility Score 53 / 100

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Executive summary

Husqvarna is easy for AI engines to find and read. It is hard for them to recommend, and impossible for an agent to buy from directly. Across the test the brand was never the top recommendation on an open question, was outranked by the LiDAR and AI-vision newcomers in every category query, and on the most-used engine was answered with a discontinued, pricier model instead of the current line. The reputation scores an engine can quote without being asked are severe. There is no agent-commerce surface on husqvarna.com.

This is the opposite shape from a typical direct-to-consumer brand. Discoverability is the strength here. The losses are in how the brand is framed, how it is rated by third parties, and whether it can be transacted.

The audit scores AI visibility across five dimensions, each from 0 to 100, averaged to a composite with a letter grade. The same framework was used for the prior Blackwell audits, so the numbers are comparable across accounts. Scores are graded against a frozen truth table of the three iQ models built from husqvarna.com before any engine was queried.

DIMENSION	WHAT IT MEASURES	SCORE	GRADE
Discoverability	Whether engines can crawl, fetch, and read the brand and its products	86	B
Quotability	Whether the product and its facts can be parsed and quoted accurately	68	C
Recommendability	Whether engines surface and rank the product on buying questions	38	F
Reputation	The third-party sentiment and ratings engines read and repeat	42	F
Transactability	Whether an AI agent can complete a purchase through the surface	30	F
Composite	Simple average across the five dimensions	53	D

For context, the rivals that displace Husqvarna in these answers, Mammotion and Segway, own the number-one slot in every open category query and carry stronger live review counts on the surface an agent actually buys from. The category Husqvarna created is being narrated by its newest competitors.

Findings, worst first

CRITICAL An agent cannot buy from Husqvarna, and the buyable surface is hard to read

husqvarna.com publishes a curated *//ms.txt* retrieval guide, which is the one technical file current engines ignore for ranking. The files that enable agent commerce are absent. Requests to */.well-known/ucp*, */.well-known/agent.json*, and */.well-known/ai-plugin.json* all return 403. There is no machine endpoint to transact against, and the site carries no checkout. The places that do sell the iQ are weak for an agent. Tractor Supply lists all three models but blocks a direct fetch and serves partly invalid review markup. Amazon publishes no schema at all, so price and rating are visible to a person but not to a machine. Home Depot does not carry the iQ line. An agent can read the Husqvarna price. It cannot complete the purchase, on Husqvarna or on most of its resellers.

CRITICAL The reputation scores an engine can quote unprompted are severe

Husqvarna sits at 1.3 out of 5 on Trustpilot across 864 reviews, with 81 percent at one star, on a profile the company has not claimed or answered. Its Better Business Bureau page shows an A+ letter rating next to a 1.04 out of 5 customer-review average, with 191 complaints in three years, most about service and warranty. The split between a high letter grade and a low customer score is the same pattern that surfaced unprompted in the Public Goods audit. The risk is compounded by a data gap. Husqvarna publishes no aggregate rating in its own product markup, so the entire rating narrative is left to third parties, and the loudest third-party numbers are the worst ones.

HIGH Engines relabel a wire-free 2026 line as the dated, expensive option

On open questions the iQ is rarely the pick. On "best robotic mower 2026" it was absent from Google AI Mode, a passing aside on ChatGPT, and a secondary "premium" mention on Perplexity behind a different brand at number one. Where it appears it is framed as premium, established, and a step behind the newer navigation, with engines advising buyers to choose it only if they want longevity over current technology. Several sources call the line "traditional" or "wired" even though it is satellite wire-free, which is a sign the corpus formed before the current product landed. On the most-used engine, a generic "Husqvarna Automower" query surfaces the discontinued 450XH at \$5,899 rather than the current iQ, so a buyer is shown the wrong, costlier model.

HIGH Price answers are stale or invented, and the rating signal is missing from the source

Hard specs are read correctly everywhere. Cutting width, battery, boundary type, and charge time were right on every engine and pass. Price is the weak cell. Of nine reads on the 410 iQ price, only about two are both current and correct. Several engines report an ended promotional price of \$1,799.99 as the live figure, which dates their pricing snapshot to late May, and two models report a \$2,999 third-party listing as the manufacturer price. The product page itself serves clean schema but an incomplete offer. It carries no GTIN, no shipping details, and no aggregate rating, and the structured-data validator flags

seventeen errors on the product node. The page qualifies to be listed by a search engine but is not a complete, machine-trustable offer.

STRENGTH **Access and entity authority are clean**

Robots policy is fully open with no rules aimed at AI crawlers, and every AI bot we tested received a byte-identical page to a normal browser, so there is no cloaking or gating. The product pages render their data server-side, so an engine that does not run JavaScript still gets the price and the specs. The knowledge graph anchors correctly. Wikidata and the Google Knowledge Panel both place Husqvarna in outdoor power equipment and lead with robotic mowers, and the collision with the separate motorcycle and sewing brands stays at the periphery. The access layer that a standard agency would audit is not where this brand is losing.

How the score works, and the variable to optimize

The five dimensions describe outcomes. To decide what to fix first, it helps to model visibility as a function of the levers a brand controls. A clean closed-form formula is not available, because engine internals are opaque and the source corpus shifts week to week. A structural model is still useful, and more useful than a regression, because it shows where the leverage is.

The key property is that visibility is gated. For a product to surface on a given question in a given engine, a sequence of conditions all have to hold, so the factors multiply rather than add.

$$V = R \times C \times K \times S \times T$$

Each factor runs 0 to 1. The product is dominated by its smallest term.

R	0.86	Retrievability. Can the engine crawl and fetch the content. Set by robots policy, bot gating, server-side rendering, and indexation. For Husqvarna this is strong.
C	0.68	Comprehensibility. Can the engine parse the product and its facts. Set by schema completeness, structured specs, and clean price and model data. Specs are strong here, the offer and rating markup are not.
K	0.42	Corroboration. Do independent sources agree the product exists and is good. Set by Reddit, reviews, video, listicles, and press. Present for Husqvarna, but the narrative is adversarial and the ratings are low.
S	0.38	Salience. Does the engine judge the product a strong fit and place it high. Set by content framing, recency, and the language the corpus uses. This is the weakest factor.
T	0.30	Transactability. Can an agent complete the purchase. Set by commerce endpoints, merchant-feed presence, and a clean buyable page. Broken on the brand site.

Multiplying the current factors gives a visibility on buying questions of roughly 0.03, and on recommendation questions, dropping the transaction term, roughly 0.09. The numbers matter less than what the structure says. Because the terms multiply, improving a strong factor does almost nothing. Lifting retrievability from 0.86 to 0.95 moves the product by about a tenth. Lifting transactability from 0.30 to 0.60 doubles it. The work that pays is on the three low factors, corroboration, salience, and transactability, in that order of leverage. The dimensions map onto the factors directly. Discoverability is R, Quotability is C, Reputation is K, Recommendability is S, and Transactability is T. Treat this as a tool for ordering the work rather than a predictor.

Dimension detail

Discoverability — 86, B

robots.txt returns a real file that allows everything and names no AI agents for exclusion. A fetch of each product page under six user agents, including GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, and Amazonbot, returned the same status and the same byte count as a normal browser, for example 655,939 bytes on the 410 iQ across every agent. Each page contains a server-rendered JSON-LD block with Product, Offer, price, and availability, so retrieval does not depend on running the page's JavaScript. The one gap is the absence of agent-discovery files, which belongs to Transactability rather than here. Nothing about being found is holding this brand back.

Quotability — 68, C

Factual recall on specifications is excellent. Across the spec and navigation prompts the cutting width of 9.4 inches, the 7.5 amp-hour battery on the 440 iQ, the boundary behavior, and the 108 minute charge time on the 410 iQ were returned correctly by every engine on every pass. Five of six engines also stated the navigation correctly as satellite positioning with radar, with no camera. The weaknesses are price and completeness. The current price is read freshly only about a fifth of the time on the 410 iQ, with an ended promotional figure and a third-party listing both displacing the real number. The product markup omits GTIN, shipping details, and an aggregate rating, and the validator reports seventeen errors on the product node. The page is readable. It is not a complete, trustable offer.

Recommendability — 38, F

This is where the account is lost. Across eighteen live captures on three engines, Husqvarna was never the top pick on an open question. On "best robotic mower 2026" it was absent from one engine and a passing mention on another. On large-yard and two-acre questions, which are the iQ line's own niche, it was outranked by Segway Navimow and Mammotion LUBA. Comparison cards consistently show the iQ as the priciest and the lowest-rated option in the set, for example a 440 iQ at 3.9 from 39 ratings next to a Navimow at 4.4 from 96. The framing is uniform across engines and listicles. The line is called premium and established and advised as the choice for buyers who value longevity over current technology. A static sweep of about fifty ranking pages matched this. The iQ is usually absent or low, and when Husqvarna appears it is often an older model. One bright spot is real. When a buyer names the 440 iQ directly, all three engines give it a fair, qualified-positive hearing on reliability and dealer support. The brand equity reads. The discovery does not.

Reputation — 42, F

The third-party corpus is large and engaged, which is good, but the sentiment is mixed and the hard scores are poor. Reddit discusses the iQ line actively and respects Husqvarna for reliability, cut quality, and dealer support, while framing it as expensive and a generation behind on navigation, with recurring complaints about satellite signal dropping under tree cover. The dealer-versus-big-box debate is common and tends to favor buying through a dealer. The two scores most likely to be quoted by an

engine are the problem, Trustpilot at 1.3 and the BBB customer average at 1.04, both driven by service and warranty complaints. Native retailer reviews are healthier, around 4.0 on Amazon, but thin, in the twenties to thirties per model, and Home Depot does not carry the line. Because the brand publishes no rating of its own, engines have only the third-party numbers to repeat.

Transactability — 30, F

An agent has no way to buy from Husqvarna. The agent-commerce and discovery endpoints return 403, and there is no checkout on the site. The resale surface is fragmented and weak for machines. The one national retailer that lists all three models blocks direct fetches and carries broken review markup, the largest marketplace publishes no structured data, and another major retailer does not stock the line at all. The contrast with the rivals is the core of the problem. Mammotion and Segway sell through a marketplace with a native agent and a deep review corpus, so an AI shopping surface can read, compare, and in many cases transact against them. Husqvarna's dealer model, which is a genuine strength for service, leaves the brand with no clean path through the channels where AI purchasing is now growing.

Competitive position

The figures below are the measured surfacing data from the live engine run and the review pull. The competitor grades are indicative reads from that data rather than full audits of those brands.

SIGNAL	HUSQVARNA AUTOMOWER IQ	MAMMOTION LUBA 3	SEGWAY NAVIMOW
Owns the top slot on open category questions	No	Often	Often
Typical framing in engine answers	Premium, established, behind on tech	Best overall, AI vision, LiDAR	Best value, easiest setup
Native reviews on the buyable surface	Thin (about 4.0, 20–36 each)	Strong (4.1–5.0)	Strong (4.4, 96)
Readable by a machine where it is sold	Mixed	No schema on marketplace	No schema on marketplace
Agent can transact through the channel	No	Marketplace agent	Marketplace agent
Surfaceable third-party rating tail	Trustpilot 1.3 / BBB 1.04	Lighter history	Lighter history
Indicative AI visibility grade	D	B	B

The newcomers are not flawless. They publish no structured data on the marketplace they sell through, and their reputation history is shorter. They win because they own the recommendation and the buyable surface, which are the two factors that decide an AI purchase today. Husqvarna leads them on owned-site readability and on entity authority, advantages that currently do no work because the recommendation and the transaction happen elsewhere.

What to fix, in order

The order follows the leverage in the model. Lift the low factors first, weighting by effort.

Tier 1 — high leverage, low effort, days to weeks

- Complete the offer markup on the three product pages. Add GTIN, shipping details, and a seller, and clear the seventeen validator errors on the product node, so the offer is machine-trustable rather than merely listable. Fixes part of C.
- Publish an aggregate rating in the product markup, sourced from the real retailer reviews near 4.0. This gives engines a rating from the brand instead of leaving them only the Trustpilot and BBB numbers. Fixes part of C and blunts K.
- Claim and answer the Trustpilot profile, and open a remediation track on the BBB complaints, which are concentrated in service and warranty. Reduces the chance an engine repeats an unanswered low score. Lifts K.
- Refresh the product pages and supporting content with 2026-dated, wire-free and EPOS-forward language, since recency and current framing both raise citation. Direct counter to the "wired" and "traditional" labels. Lifts S.

Tier 2 — high impact, medium effort, weeks to a quarter

- Resolve the model sprawl. Make the iQ the canonical current consumer line and clearly date or retire the indexable pages for the discontinued 430X and 450X, so engines stop answering a generic Husqvarna query with the wrong, costlier model. Lifts S and C.
- Work the corpus where buying opinion forms. Engage on Reddit and with the video and listicle publishers, supply a factual answer to the satellite-dropout narrative, and get the iQ into the 2026 rankings it is currently missing from. Lifts K and S.
- Establish a standalone Automower entity in Wikipedia and Wikidata so the line owns its authority rather than inheriting it from the parent group. Lifts K.

Tier 3 — strategic, the agent-commerce layer

- Build agent-commerce readiness. With no checkout on the site, the paths are to expose a discovery and handoff endpoint for agents, to place the iQ in the integrated retailer feeds that AI shopping surfaces now transact against, or to stand up a branded agent endpoint. This is the layer no web or SEO agency covers, and the rivals' marketplace buyability is beating Husqvarna on it now. Lifts T.
- Stand up cross-engine monitoring. Engine answers drift weekly, so visibility needs a standing measurement rather than a one-time read.

Why this is not an agency job

Husqvarna has a capable digital team and outside agencies, so the reasonable question is why this work sits outside their scope. The answer is that the problem is not in their remit. This is cross-engine AI behavior measurement, entity disambiguation across the model sprawl and the five-brand name collision, schema engineering for the emerging agent-commerce standards, and reputation-signal work against a fragmented dealer network. A web build or a keyword SEO program does none of it. The proof that the clock is running is on the page already. The newcomers who entered the category Husqvarna created now own its top recommendations and the surface where it is bought.

The first phase is a fixed-scope remediation sprint against the Tier 1 list, with a re-measurement of the scorecard at the end so the change is verified rather than asserted. Phase two is the ongoing visibility and agent-readiness work. Scope and fee follow in a separate engagement letter.

Method note. Six engines were tested, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot, and Google AI Mode, with browsing off and on where the interface allows. All spec, price, and navigation answers were graded against a truth table built from husqvarna.com on June 2, 2026. Access, schema, and agent-file findings were captured by direct request and structured-data validation. Reputation and mention findings were captured from Reddit, YouTube, Trustpilot, the BBB, retailer listings, and a sweep of ranking pages. Captured prices reflect a June 2, 2026 reading, after the late-May promotional period had ended.